BEST PRACTICES IN LAND-USE REGULATION AND MUNICIPAL INFRASTRUCTURE FINANCING

A Proposal to Canadian Mortgage and Housing Corporation

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Background

- Shortages in housing supply and affordability in Canada continues to be a critical and complex challenge involving multiple variables and key players. The speed and feasibility of new housing supply rely on design of land-use regulations, zoning by-laws, development approval processes, and their financing mechanisms (such as permit fees, development charges, and land transfer taxes).
- The impact of municipal regulations and municipal financing mechanisms may vary across the country due to differences in their design and scope (CMHC 2023). But they often impact the cost of building new housing for developers and result in slowdown in constructing new supply of housing. The additional costs for developer can drive up the price for the potential homebuyer (and investors) resulting in worsening housing affordability for homebuyers and renters.
- Although municipal regulations and financing mechanisms are in purview of the municipal governments, provincial and territorial government provide a framework to this purview through enabling legislation.
- In Canada, municipal and local policies are intertwined with federal, provincial and territorial policies. Municipal and local governments receive their regulatory powers from their respective provincial or territorial government and in some cases, there are concurrent responsibilities. Insights on effective land-use regulations and development financing mechanisms can help inform public policy decisions for all levels of government in Canada to further advance increased housing supply that is affordable to meet housing demand.
- All orders of governments in Canada are taking steps to help address housing supply and affordability challenges across the country, however, supply shortages and costs continue to increase.
    - The Government of Canada's Housing Accelerator Fund, launched in 2023, provides funding to local/municipal governments to grow housing supply while supporting affordable, diverse, and community resilient communities.
    - In the Speech from the Throne delivered on May 27, 2025, the Government of Canada reiterated its commitment to increase supply of housing to improve affordability and emphasized its desire to see improvements in the housing market by cutting municipal development charges in half for all multi-unit housing.
    - Government of Canada's Budget 2025 emphasizes the need to accelerate homebuilding to close Canada's housing supply gap, including the need to double housing starts to restore affordability. It emphasizes the need to modernize regulatory frameworks to speed up construction. Budget 2025 also outlines a "generational investment strategy" for infrastructure, highlighting the importance of strategic infrastructure, including housing-related infrastructure among others, underscoring community-level benefits through large-scale national programs.
- The adverse impact of existing land-use regulations and development funding and financing mechanisms on speed and affordability of new housing supply is not unique to Canada. The Housing Advisory Board recommendations to the European Commission (2025) recommended the need to accelerate planning process to reduce cost of construction. To accomplish this, the Board recommends "fundamental reforms of land governance systems" where "costs are more equally distributed between public authorities and developers" (21).

This document outlines a proposal for a mixed-methods, exploratory study

exploring children and teens' engagement with and behaviors associated with restaurant M2K to inform methods for Health Canada's strategies to monitor restaurant M2K. Of note, the Contractor has completed the Women and Gender Equality Canada's Gender-based Analysis Plus course (GBA+), and will bring an equity and diversity lens to all aspects of the research. Of particular importance will be to examine how gender, immigrant status, visible minority and Indigenous status, and rural vs. urban residence is associated with reported behaviors in both studies. The proposal outlines two distinct but complementary projects:

1. A qualitative study (online, one-on-one video interviews) with children (ages 9-12) and youth (ages 13-17) to explore how they engage with restaurant M2K, both point-of-sale and other forms of restaurant

M2K (e.g., apps, social media), and how these ways of engaging of have changed over the course of the pandemic.

2. A quantitative survey, building on findings from the first project, with 1,500 children and youth across Canada (in all 10 provinces) to estimate the prevalence of these behaviors and engagement strategies with restaurant M2K for Canadian children and youth ages 9-17.

Objectives and Deliverables of the Requirement

The two projects outlined above are associated with objectives and deliverables, which are listed below.

1. **Qualitative Study Objective**: To explore and report on how children and youth ages 9-17 engage with restaurant marketing (point-of-sale and other), the extent to which and how these ways of engaging have reportedly changed over the course of the pandemic, and whether children and youth anticipate these ways of engaging might change when pandemic-related restrictions have been lifted.
   a. **Deliverables**:
   i. Dataset containing qualitative data from one-on-one interviews with Canadian children and youth (approximately 20-30 participants, or until saturation is reached).
   ii. A report and documentation of results and themes emerging from the data analysis, with implications to inform M2K monitoring in Canada.
   iii. Documentation of how qualitative results will be used to inform quantitative questionnaire development.
2. **Quantitative Study Objective**: to estimate the prevalence and frequency of behaviours associated with restaurant M2K (point-of-sale and other), reported changes related to engagement strategies or behaviours related to restaurant M2K over the course of the pandemic, and how participants anticipate engaging with restaurant M2K post-pandemic in a pan-Canadian sample of children and teens. A secondary objective of this project will be to explore participants' knowledge and awareness of Canada's Food Guide, and to explore associations between participant's knowledge/awareness of the Food Guide and engagement with restaurant M2K.
   a. **Deliverables**:
   i. Dataset containing quantitative data from n = 1500 Canadian children and teens (ages 9-17) from all 10 provinces (unfortunately the sample excludes participants from Canada's territories).
   ii. A report and documentation of results from the survey, with implications to inform M2K monitoring in Canada.

Timeline:

June 2021 – March 2022

Budget:

The budget is presented according to the two projects outlined above. The total budget for both projects is $40,000 (includes 5% overhead).

Tasks, Activities, and Deliverables

Tasks and Activities	Deliverables and Milestones	Timeline	Payment Schedule
Project 1: Qualitative Project			
Step 1: Contractor to submit ethics approval to UW	Ethics approval – UW	Within 3 weeks of contract start date	
Step 2: Contractor to submit ethics approval to Health Canada REB	Ethics approval – HC REB	Within 2 weeks of UW ethics approval	

Step 3: Contractor to recruit and collect qualitative interview data from participants aged 9-17 years from the Youth Engagement Team (YET), other networks, and snowball sample (total of 20-30 participants, or until saturation is reached).	Recruit Participants Data Collection	By August 31, 2021	$26,500
Step 4: Contractor to submit data analysis plan	Analysis plan	By August 31, 2021	
Step 5: Contractor to submit summary report outline	Summary report outline	By September 15, 2021	
Step 6: Contractor to submit preliminary data analysis	Preliminary data analysis	By September 30, 2021	
Step 7: Contractor to submit draft summary report	Draft summary report	By October 15, 2021	
Step 8: Contractor to submit final summary report and preliminary data files	Final summary report Preliminary data files	By October 31, 2021	
Step 9: Contractor to present to Health Canada Staff	Presentation	By November 15, 2021	
Project 2: Quantitative Project			
Step 1: Contractor to submit ethics approval to UW	Ethics approval – UW	By September 30, 2021	
Step 2: Contractor to submit ethics approval to Health Canada REB	Ethics approval – HC REB	Within 2 weeks of UW ethics approval	
Step 3: Contractor to recruit and collect qualitative interview data from 1500 participants aged 9-17 years from Leger through the UW Survey Research Centre	Recruit Participants Data Collection	By December 20, 2021	
Step 4: Contractor to submit data analysis plan	Analysis plan	By January 15, 2022	
Step 5: Contractor to submit summary report outline	Summary report outline	By February 1, 2022	
Step 6: Contractor to submit preliminary data analysis	Preliminary data analysis	By February 15, 2022	
Step 7: Contractor to submit draft summary report	Draft summary report	By March 1, 2022	
Step 8: Contractor to submit final summary report and preliminary data files	Final summary report Preliminary data files	By March 15, 2022	$13,500
Step 9: Contractor to present to Health Canada Staff	Presentation	By March 31, 2022	
Consult with Health Canada Representative throughout the project		ongoing	
		TOTAL*	$40,000

*Includes 5% overhead

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